The "Friendslop" Games Surge: Market & Financial Overview

Filter by Genre: All

Filter by Era: 2023+ | Pre-2023

Market & Financial Overview | Player Acquisition & Virality | Sentiment & Product Quality

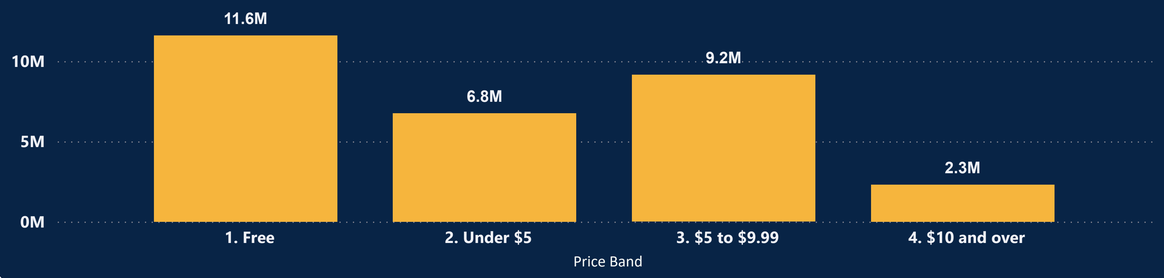
Total Games	Median Owners	Total Reviews Sampled	Median Peak Players
33	7M	3,043	46K

Key Findings:

- **Price Sweet Spot**: Paid games at $5–$9.99 lead on median peak players (107K) and revenue (about $43M); $10+ games have the smallest audiences (2.3M).
- **Modern Virality**: 2023+ games peak 3.4x higher (71K vs 21K median) without larger audiences.
- **The 2025 Spike**: Three hits (Schedule I, R.E.P.O., PEAK) make up about 89% of that year's combined peak players.

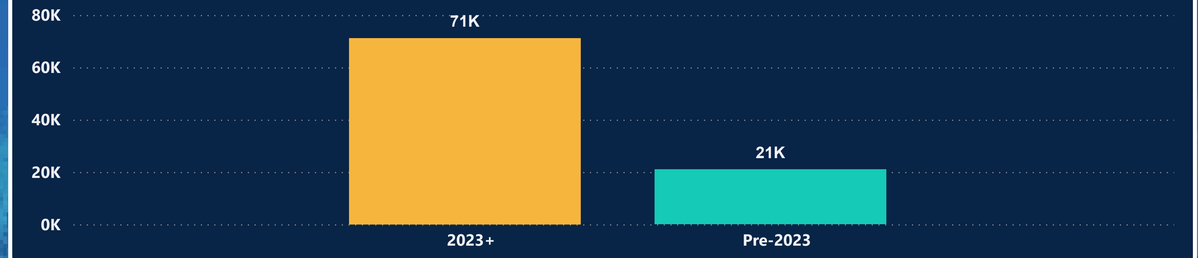
Ownership Distribution by Price

Free and $5–$9.99 titles have the largest median audiences, while games $10+ see a steep drop-off.



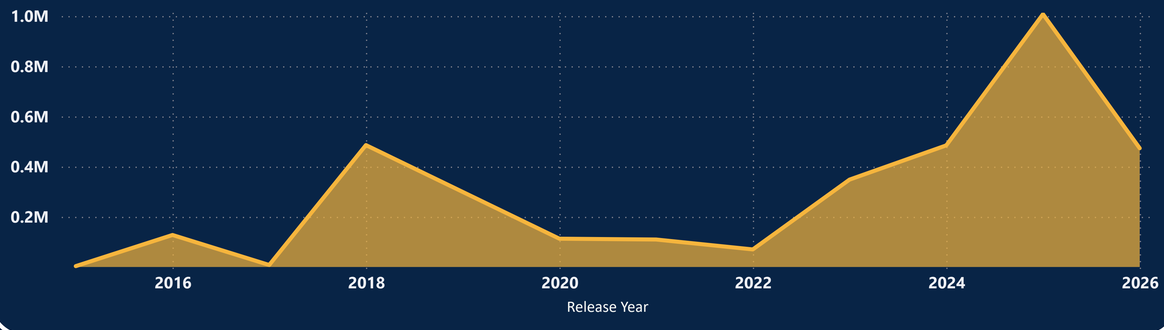
Peak Concurrent Players by Era

Post-2023 titles achieve 3.4x higher peak engagement (71K vs 21K median) than older releases.



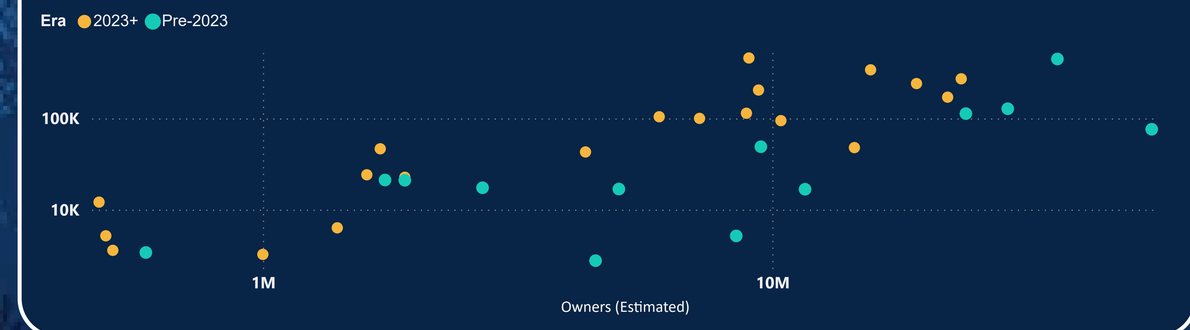
Peak Players by Release Year

Three 2025 hits make up about 90% of that year's peak; 2026 is a partial year



Player Base vs. Peak Engagement

Newer games reach higher peaks without larger audiences; log scale



n = 33 hand-picked games. Owners are Gamalytic estimates. Reviews are the latest 100 per game.

The "Friendslop" Games Surge: Player Acquisition & Virality

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Market & Financial Overview | **Player Acquisition & Virality** | Sentiment & Product Quality

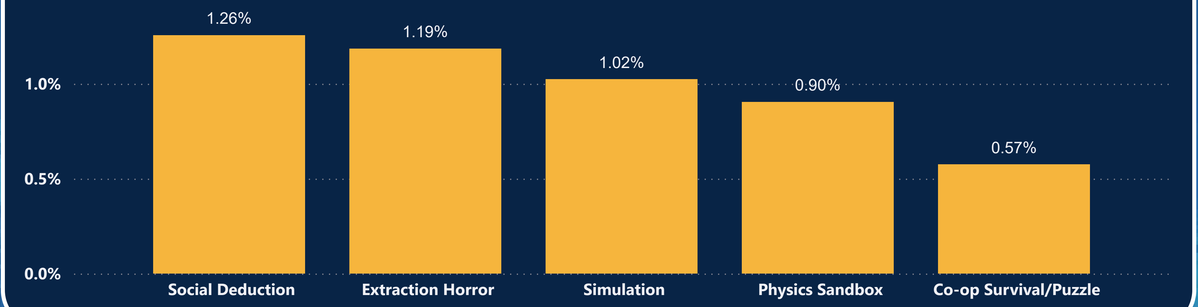
Key Findings:

- **Social Deduction & Extraction Horror Lead**: Highest median peak intensity (1.26% and 1.19%) and the largest median audiences (about 12M and 14M); Co-op Survival/Puzzle is lowest (0.57%).
- **Niche Isn't Disengaged**: Task Coordination games have the smallest median audience (1.9M) but the highest median peak intensity (about 1.5%).
- **Reach by Social Feature**: Deception games have the largest median audience (15.6M, only 3 games), followed by Proximity Chat (9.5M, 11 games).

Peak intensity = all-time peak concurrent players ÷ estimated owners. A higher number means a larger share of owners were playing at the same time

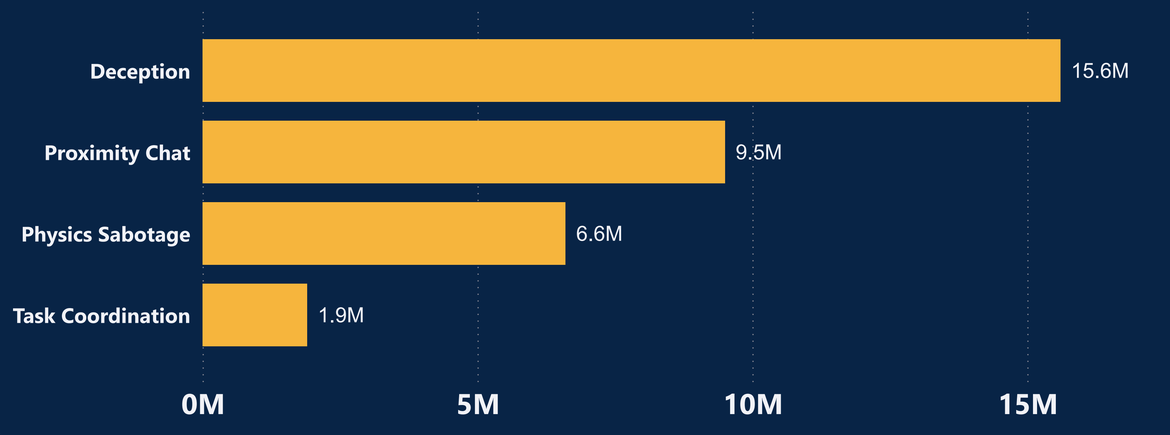
Peak Intensity by Sub-Genre

Median of all-time peak players ÷ estimated owners; 4 to 9 games per sub-genre



Median Owners by Social Feature

Deception mechanics command the largest overall reach, 8x higher than task coordination.



Game Performance & Peak Intensity Breakdown

Schedule I has the highest peak intensity (5.1%); Crab Game has the most estimated owners (55.6M)

Game	Sub-Genre	Estimated Owners	Peak Players	Peak Intensity %
Schedule I	Simulation	9.0M	459.08K	5.10%
Big Walk	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	1.7M	46.41K	2.73%
Retro Rewind - Video Store Simulator	Simulation	0.5M	12.08K	2.53%
Mecha Chameleon	Social Deduction	15.6M	340.53K	2.18%
Content Warning	Extraction Horror	9.4M	204.44K	2.17%
Party Animals	Physics Sandbox	6.0M	104.17K	1.74%
Webfishing	Physics Sandbox	1.6M	24.09K	1.51%
RV There Yet?	Physics Sandbox	7.2M	100.00K	1.39%
Liar's Bar	Social Deduction	8.9M	113.80K	1.28%
Lethal Company	Extraction Horror	19.2M	240.82K	1.25%
Among Us	Social Deduction	36.3M	447.48K	1.23%
Project Playtime	Extraction Horror	1.7M	21.11K	1.21%
Machine Party	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	1.9M	22.63K	1.19%
R.E.P.O.	Extraction Horror	23.5M	271.57K	1.16%
Pummel Party	Physics Sandbox	1.9M	20.96K	1.10%
Kebab Chefs! - Restaurant Simulator	Simulation	0.5M	5.16K	1.05%
Gamble With Your Friends	Simulation	4.3M	42.85K	1.00%
Chained Together	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	10.4M	94.48K	0.91%
PEAK	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	22.1M	170.76K	0.77%
PratFall	Physics Sandbox	0.5M	3.58K	0.70%
Overcooked 2	Simulation	2.7M	17.36K	0.64%
Keep Talking and Nobody Explodes	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	0.6M	3.39K	0.57%
Escape The Backrooms	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	9.5M	48.88K	0.51%
Phasmophobia	Extraction Horror	24.0M	112.72K	0.47%
The Headliners	Extraction Horror	1.4M	6.32K	0.45%
Human Fall Flat	Physics Sandbox	29.0M	127.52K	0.44%
Pico Park	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	5.0M	16.80K	0.34%
Supermarket Together	Simulation	14.5M	47.84K	0.33%

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The "Friendslop" Games Surge: Sentiment & Product Quality

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Key Findings:

- **Jank Is What Players Punish:** Bug words appear in 13.3% of Not Recommended reviews vs 2.3% of Recommended, about 6x as often.
- **Chaos Is a Small Signal:** Chaos words appear in 5.4% of Recommended vs 2.9% of Not Recommended reviews (about 2x), with no clear link to audience size.
- **Bug Talk and Ratings:** Games with more bug mentions tend to have lower positive-review shares, but the link is weak (r ≈ -0.3 across 33 games).

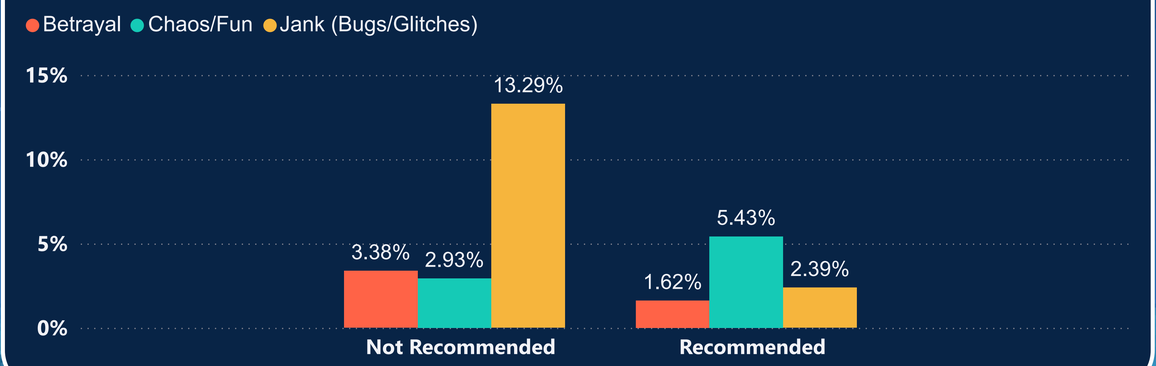
Game Quality & Review Sentiment Breakdown

% of scored reviews containing a keyword. Machine Party has the highest chaos rate (16.0%); The Headliners the highest jank rate (17.9%)

Game	Sub-Genre	Jank (Bugs) %	Chaos %
Machine Party	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	1.00	16.00
Overcooked 2	Simulation	2.10	13.50
Content Warning	Extraction Horror	5.50	9.90
Pico Park	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	1.10	9.70
Lethal Company	Extraction Horror	0.00	7.90
Hand Simulator	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	3.00	7.10
Liar's Bar	Social Deduction	7.50	6.50
The Headliners	Extraction Horror	17.90	6.30
Retro Rewind - Video Store Simulator	Simulation	7.20	6.20
Pummel Party	Physics Sandbox	1.20	6.10
PratFall	Physics Sandbox	4.50	5.60
Stick Fight: The Game	Physics Sandbox	2.20	5.40
R.E.P.O.	Extraction Horror	3.20	5.30
Human Fall Flat	Physics Sandbox	1.20	4.70
Chained Together	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	3.40	4.60
Escape The Backrooms	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	3.40	4.50
Crab Game	Physics Sandbox	5.50	4.40
Keep Talking and Nobody Explodes	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	0.00	4.40
Muck	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	1.10	4.40
PEAK	Co-op Survival/Puzzle	2.10	4.30
Deceit 2	Social Deduction	5.30	4.20
Phasmophobia	Extraction Horror	4.40	3.30
RV There Yet?	Physics Sandbox	5.50	3.30
Gamble With Your Friends	Simulation	4.30	3.20
Party Animals	Physics Sandbox	0.00	2.30
Among Us	Social Deduction	2.20	2.20
Mecha Chameleon	Social Deduction	2.20	2.20
Supermarket Together	Simulation	2.20	2.20

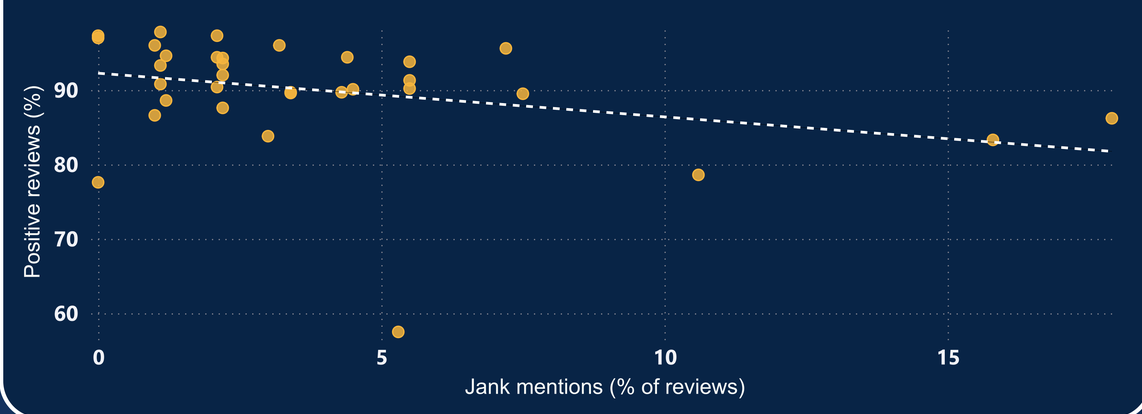
Keyword Density by Review Sentiment

% of scored reviews with at least one keyword from each bucket; betrayal is rare (57 matches)



The Jank Penalty: Bug Rates vs. Positive Sentiment

Each dot is one game; weak negative relationship (r ≈ -0.3, n = 33)



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